

McDonnell Douglas F-4 Phantom II

The mighty McDonnell Douglas F-4 Phantom II first flew in 1958 and remains in front-line service today. This large and highly adaptable fighter-bomber earned its formidable reputation during the Vietnam War and in later years proved itself in combat with the air forces of both Israel and Iran.

ONE OF THE FIRST aircraft to reach Mach 2, the F-4 Phantom started its service as an interceptor for the US Navy. Fast, well-armed, and with a long range, it was the match of any fighter. The US Air Force and the US Marine Corps were so impressed by the aircraft that they also ordered it. It broke many world records and in 1961 set an absolute speed world record at

1,606 mph (2,585 km/h). It was first used in combat during the Vietnam War, where it proved effective, but was marred by its lack of a gun. This was initially solved by the addition of a gun pod, and later variations carried internal cannons. The F-4s performed fighter, bomber, reconnaissance, and defense suppression missions in Vietnam and destroyed more than 100 enemy aircraft.



FRONT VIEW

